

Performance Conversations

Employee Guide

Year-End Connect: Performance Conversations

Your Year-End Connect conversation is a key milestone in Aristocrat's performance and development cycle. This guide is designed to help you prepare for a meaningful and productive conversation, one that not only captures your contributions, but also helps shape your career direction for the year ahead.

You'll use your completed Year-End Connect form in Workday as a foundation for your discussion. Your manager will review your self-reflection, values assessment, and performance rating, and will also share feedback and insights from the calibration process. This conversation is a two-way dialogue where your preparation can make all the difference.

This guide will help you:

- ✓ Reflect on your impact, challenges, and development over the past year.
- ✓ Prepare talking points, questions, and examples for your conversation.
- ✓ Build confidence to have open, honest, and forward-focused discussions.
- ✓ Explore how to actively engage and ask for the support you need.

Key Dates & Action Items

19 October to 30 October

Managers will conduct performance conversations with employee(s)

End of Q1 OR earlier based on guidance provided by manager:

Enter goals in Workday (New hires to complete goals in Workday within first 90 days)

Additional Resources:

Connect Page:

☐ [Talent Practices & Enablement – Year-End Connect](#)

Goal Setting resources:

☐ [Ally SharePoint – Goal Setting](#)

Values resource:

☐ [Aristocrat Values](#)



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Tips on Preparing for the Performance Review Conversation



Reflect on Your Past Performance

Spend time reviewing how you've performed over this past year

Below are sample reflection questions you can prepare ahead of your meeting:

- ☐ What were the trends in the feedback you received?
- ☐ How have you contributed to the organization's success?
- ☐ What would you describe as your biggest strength?
- ☐ What one skill would you like to develop to improve in your current role?

Below are sample questions you could ask your manager:

- ☐ What could I have done differently to improve ___ during this past year?
- ☐ What was my biggest impact on the business this past year?
- ☐ What challenges should I take on to build my skill in ___?
- ☐ Which leadership behavior should I focus on for my own development?



Reflect on Your Future Aspirations

Think about the skills, experiences, and connections you want to gain going forward and come to the performance conversation ready to share with your manager.

Below are sample reflection questions to prepare ahead of your meeting:

- ☐ What skills do I need to keep developing to be successful in my current role? What do I see as my development areas?
- ☐ What do I see as my strengths? How will I keep using them?
- ☐ What skills do I want to learn in the future?
- ☐ How can my manager best help me achieve my career goals?

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Checklist	Action
☐ Listen to your managers review or assessment of your performance	✓ Your manager will discuss both your strengths and development areas. Actively listen and take notes.
☐ Share your feedback	✓ Actively share your perspective on your performance, using your notes from your reflection questions in the prior page. ✓ Ask questions if you do not understand your managers assessment.
☐ Consider how you react to the review	✓ While discussing your performance, it's normal to have an emotional response, even a strong one. Below are a few tips on how you can respond to constructive feedback: ✓ Tell your manager you need a moment to reflect and take some deep breaths. ✓ Look for the positive in the review and ask for help to understand how to do better. ✓ Tell your manager how you are feeling with expressions like "I feel" or "I am." ✓ Tell your manager what you need more specific feedback or help on.
☐ Discuss future development	✓ Share what your development and career aspirations are. ✓ Tell your manager how they can help you achieve those aspirations (e.g., training, program, mentorship, etc.) ✓ Revisit your Individual Development Plan (IDP) to update after your performance conversation.
☐ Plan ongoing conversations & Goals	✓ If not already scheduled, set a regular cadence to have regular check-ins around your performance and development. ✓ Partner with your manager to establish clear, measurable, and achievable goals for the new fiscal year that align with your professional development and business unit priorities.

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Remember the Importance of Active Listening

Be open to feedback:

Show genuine interest in your managers perspective. Feedback is a crucial part of your professional development and approaching it with a growth mindset can help you achieve your goals.

Remove distractions:

Turn off your phone or programs on your computer, such as MS Teams, Zoom, Slack, and e-mail.

Take notes:

If you do not understand what your manager is saying or their feedback sparks an idea, write it down to discuss.

Reply with purpose:

Paraphrase often to make sure you understand what your manager is saying.

Take your time:

Don't be afraid of silence. If you need a moment to collect your thoughts, ask for it.



Engage to Get What You Need

Speak up:

After hearing your managers review, spend most of the time giving your perspective objectively, focusing on fact-based information.

Own the conversation:

The performance review is for your growth and development. Steer the conversation to the topics you need to cover. Ask for the feedback you need.

Ask open-ended questions:

For example, "How could I have collaborated more with colleagues this year?" or "What are we doing that works well?"

Say what you need:

Your manager's job is to help you perform and grow. Let them know what you need from them to succeed.

Propose solutions:

If you have ideas for how to continue using your strengths or growing in your development areas, tell your manager so you can plan how to implement them together.

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LinkedIn Learning Resources

Looking to prepare for your Year-End Connect Performance Conversation? Click on each of the boxes to view quick LinkedIn Learning videos that offer practical tips to guide your reflection and enhance your conversations.

The Art and Science of Feedback

Learn how to give and receive high-quality feedback.

Create a Growth Mindset with Feedback

Learn how adopting a growth mindset can help you view feedback as an opportunity for continuous improvement and personal development.

Use Feedback to Write Your Story

Learn how to process feedback constructively, regardless of your mood, and use it to write your own story for personal growth and development.

During the Performance Evaluation

Learn key behaviors to practice during your performance review, such as effective listening, handling criticism positively, tying your performance to career goals, and showing appreciation to your supervisor.

Listen with Empathy

Learn how to listen with empathy by mirroring the speaker's emotions and body language, which helps build trust, respect, and better understanding in both professional and personal interactions.

Seeking Feedback to Boost Self-Awareness

Learn how to effectively seek feedback from others to enhance your self-awareness, including tips on making feedback a regular habit, asking specific questions, and listening without judgment.